



Google Chrome for iOS

After a long time wait, Google finally released the Chrome browser for iOS devices at Google's I/O developer conference. <http://dgit.in/N1FAOW>



Ushering in iPad Mini

The 7-8 inch tablet is expected to debut by the end of the year, with rumors of collaboration with LG Display. <http://dgit.in/M6ioy8>

Nikon D4

Nikon's latest full-frame beast



Specifications

Sensor: 16.2MP CMOS;
Image Processor: EXPEED 3;
ISO Range: 100 - 12800;
Burst mode: 10 fps; **Max Video Resolution:** 1920x1080 (30,25,24 fps)

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Price: ₹3,24,995

8.0/10

Features 8.0
 Performance 8.5
 Build Quality 9.0
 Value for Money 7.0

It's big, it's fast, and if you fling it at someone's face, chances are they'd break a bone or two while the camera wouldn't show any sign of damage. Yes, we are talking about the Nikon D4, the new beast that takes the stage after the D3 and the D3s have had their fair share of the lime light. The camera packs in quite a bit of new tech along with a 16 megapixel full-frame sensor, a redesigned 51-point focus system and a burst mode of 10 fps.

The Nikon D4 is built of solid magnesium alloy along with an extensive network of weather seals, making this beast an ideal buy for photographers who are constantly roughing it out (wildlife, sports etc). One thing to keep in mind though is that the "weather seal" is only complete when a weather sealed lens is attached to the camera, as these have a rubber gasket at the lens mounting end which seals the gap between the lens and the

mount, so as to prevent any water or dust from accidentally slipping in and ruining the sensor.

Along with the host of buttons that riddle the left and underside of the 3.2" LCD screen, there is also a multi-directional joystick that can be assigned to do a slew of things, but we chose to have it control out focus points. A similar stick can be found on the grip, to ease shooting in portrait mode.

In our use of the Nikon D4, we found that most of the settings require two-hand-one-eye use. What that means is that changing certain settings requires the use of both hands; one to press the corresponding button and the other to spin the dial that would change the value. The positioning of such combination often required us to remove the camera from our eyes, which we sometimes found to be an inconvenience.

Nikon boasts of the D4's novel focusing system, which throws a whopping 51 points that not only works in lower light but also works well with smaller apertures in those same conditions. We tossed the D4 around in some of the worst lighting imaginable – club lighting. It had no issues locking focus in the extreme low light. Focus performance was no different when the lights went on a frenzy, comparable to a little child experiencing a sugar rush. We even went ahead and shot a bunch of hooligans playing a game of basketball, just to see how good the AF was at keeping track of the man with the ball. 9 out of 10 shots were keepers (and we're shooting in low light here mind you!)

Accompanying the AF chip is the 91,000 pixel sensor dedicated to the task of making sure your photos are as accurately metered and white balanced as possible. This is why despite the crazy, constantly changing lights, our exposure values were within the range of what we consider "good exposure" (a maximum adjustment of 1/3 of a stop) along with the focus being spot on. Following in the footsteps of the stellar AF and metering system is the heart of the D4, a 16 megapixel full frame sensor that captures images in absolutely amazing detail. Even as the ISO numbers got bumped up from 800 to 6400 (even 8000 at one point), detail retention was stellar, while the noise levels remained extremely low.

The camera shoots fast and it shoots well. It even, for the first time in its class, offers proper full HD video recording. Once again at the club, we shot some footage and noticed our ISO jumping to 5000. When viewing that footage on a 32-inch LCD TV, we failed to see any noise. Let that be a testament of the power of the D4.

Well, all that power and performance comes at a cost and the Nikon D4 is pegged at a price of ₹3,24,995. Peanuts if you're part of that one per cent of the elite and just a fond dream for the rest of us.

Swapnil Mathur

CORRIGENDUM

We are repeating this review from last month, since we erroneously published ratings for some other product. Our sincere apologies to our readers for the confusion.